

SENG 310 ASSIGNMENT 2: TEAM B03-07

PARTICIPANT SUMMARY

Over the course of our process of understanding people, we interviewed several students at the University of Victoria to gather their perspectives regarding a scheduling app that potentially provides you with more time to spend with their friends. Below are the first names of the different participants we interviewed and the justifications as to why we interviewed them.

1. **Vidit** - A third year computer science student who provides a perspective of someone that usually utilizes a rough week-to-week schedule rather than an event-based scheduling approach.
2. **Abheenaya** - An economics major who grants a perspective of someone that uses a calendar app, is a part of multiple groups and deals with conflicts regarding managing time between multiple friend groups.
3. **Harshad** - A computer science major who is very comfortable with technology and uses a wide array of tools to plan and coordinate events already. Also 'hangs out' with a large number of friend groups, and also struggles with planning 'hangouts'. Also initiates a lot of events.
4. **Shreya** - A biochemistry major perspective of an individual that does not really use online scheduling apps or paper schedules. Does not initiate 'hangout'/planning, but still participates enthusiastically. Is also not very comfortable with technology. We chose this participant since she gives a different perspective (people who don't use calendar apps) and also does not initiate planning.
5. **Krishika** - An economics major who enjoys planning frequent social activities but struggles to juggle multiple friend groups while also juggling academics, work and personal commitments. She provides the perspective of someone who already uses Google Calendar regularly and wants smoother integration of planning tools to avoid stress and double-booking.
6. **Navya** - A business major who values casual hangouts and finds it frustrating when plans fall through due to frequent scheduling conflicts. She represents the perspective of someone who does not actively use calendar tools but would benefit from a lightweight, low-effort way to coordinate with friends and ensure that no one is left out.
7. **Devanshi** - A political science major who while balancing academics, two jobs, and multiple social groups, making her scheduling particularly complex. She provides the perspective of someone who uses Google Calendar but still faces challenges in aligning with others. She prioritizes important milestones and would benefit from group-focused scheduling features with built-in messaging and notifications.
8. **Apoorva** - A computer science major in second year, who has multiple friend groups, in and out of the country. Deals with difficulty in coming up with a common time to video call her friends back home and also hanging out with friends in person.

INTERVIEW METHOD

We carried out the interviews in person and used a semi-structured format. This gave us a good balance: we asked everyone the same set of core questions, but we also had the freedom to follow up on interesting points that came up. Doing the interviews face-to-face helped create a more natural conversation and let us pick up on nonverbal cues, which we might have missed in an online setting.

Most of the interviews took place in different spots around campus, which made participants feel comfortable in familiar surroundings and sometimes gave extra context to their answers. Two interviews were done at the participants' homes, which allowed for a more personal and relaxed environment. On average, each interview lasted about ten minutes—long enough to collect meaningful insights, but not so long that it felt like a burden for the participants.

TASK DESCRIPTIONS

1. ABILITY TO CREATE YOUR PERSONAL SCHEDULE ON THE APP

Vidit is a third-year student at the University of Victoria who currently uses either a paper calendar or the calendar app on his phone to plan out his week. He usually budgets his time out in advance in order to accommodate time to spend with his friends. During his interview, he expressed interest in a technology that allows his friends and him to add their schedules to an app and share it so that they could meet more often. The key first component in this is the ability of all members of the group to create their own personal schedule on the app.

Discussion:

Vidit and his friend group serve as a good yardstick for most university-going students that have different work schedules, study schedules and class schedules and he expressed an interest in the ability to view all these components separately in his friend's schedules. Based on this, we think it is essential for our users to be able to input their own schedules into the app, and colour code them based on the different parts of life that they have blocked those times for (E.g blue for work, green for class, orange for study). This color coding idea for different aspects of blocked time was also suggested by Abheenaya during her interview. They should be able to also view and edit their inputted schedule due to spontaneous time commitments that occur.

2. ABILITY TO JOIN MULTIPLE GROUPS

Abheenaya is a fourth-year economics student at the University of Victoria who struggles with scheduling conflicts as a result of budgeting her time across multiple groups. She uses Google Calendar to aid her in doing this but then also expressed that a lot of the time this still gets lost in translation. She also discussed how she sometimes forgets that she planned something with a particular group and has a

tendency to double book, resulting in her having to say no to one or more friends/groups.

Discussion:

Abheenaya depicts a part of the user base that has a very active social life and interactions with multiple friend-groups/friends. Based on our discoveries, we think that a user should be able to join multiple user groups corresponding to different friend groups and view a calendar that contains the schedules of the different people that are a part of that group. This calendar should also have time dedicated to other groups blocked out in order to provide the user with reasonable confidentiality. Abheenaya also suggested color coding schedules of different members with different colours during her interview in order to better organise time.

3. ABILITY TO VIEW A GROUP'S CALENDAR

Harsadh, a third-year student, often finds it difficult to keep track of events across his different friend groups. He enjoys going out to eat or trying new activities with friends, but he frequently experiences plans falling apart because of last-minute conflicts — for example, when some people suddenly had gym or cricket plans, which caused a restaurant outing to be canceled. What he wants is a clear way to see when his friends are busy or free, all in one shared calendar, so he can plan confidently without relying only on messy group chats. He also mentioned that it would be ideal if this feature integrated into tools he already uses, such as Google Calendar or Apple Calendar, instead of requiring a completely new app.

Discussion:

Harsadh reflects the typical student user who is active in multiple groups, values social activities, and struggles with overlapping commitments. His experience shows that scheduling conflicts are a frequent and frustrating barrier to spending time with friends. Being able to view a shared group calendar directly addresses this pain point by reducing miscommunication and helping him plan hangouts more efficiently. Because many students already rely on existing digital calendars, integration with familiar tools was highlighted as important for adoption.

4. GROUP SHOULD LET YOU KNOW THE COMMON FREE TIMES AMONG PARTICIPANTS

Apoorva, a second-year student, often struggles to coordinate time with friends both on and off campus. She explained that hangout plans fail “very frequently” because people have different class times, labs, or deadlines. Even when everyone wants to meet, they can’t always find a common free slot. She feels this issue is worse when her friends are in different majors, since their schedules rarely align. Apoorva wants a way for the app to automatically highlight when all members of a group are free so that plans don’t collapse due to last-minute conflicts. She mentioned that she would use this feature regularly, even checking it “every day,” because it would simplify coordination and help her spend more time reconnecting with friends.

Discussion:

Apoorva reflects a typical university student who values maintaining her social connections but finds that scheduling conflicts regularly prevent it. Her description highlights how common free times are critical for making plans happen. This task is frequent and important for students balancing academics, labs, and social life.

Automating the process of finding overlap reduces frustration, prevents cancellations, and makes scheduling more reliable. Integration with existing calendars, which she suggested, shows that students want convenience and familiar tools to make adoption easier.

PERSONAS

Persona 1

SHANAYA OBEROI

20 y.o

A social and easygoing student who prefers last-minute plans and just wants hanging out with friends to feel simple and stress-free.

LOCATION

Victoria
British Columbia, Canada

OCCUPATION

- Student at University of Victoria
- Currently working in a Co-op Canadian Company

DIGITAL BEHAVIOR

- Relies on WhatsApp/Instagram DMs for planning
- Rarely uses calendars unless prompted
- More likely to respond to notifications than proactively check an app
- Prefers quick polls or activity suggestions instead of detailed planning

BACKGROUND

Shanaya values spending time with his friends but finds it hard to coordinate with their busy schedules. She often prefers last-minute hangouts and relies on group chats. She doesn't enjoy setting up calendars and wants an easier way to know when her friends are free.

TECH USE

- Uses messaging apps (WhatsApp, Messenger, Instagram)
- Rarely updates Google Calendar, mostly remembers schedules mentally
- Prefers simple and easy ways to plan "hangouts"

GOALS:

- Hang out with friends without the hassle of long planning
- Find quick activities everyone can agree on
- Get reminders so she doesn't miss plans

"I don't want to spend hours planning. Just tell me when my friends are free and what we can do."



PAIN POINTS

- Plans often fall apart due to scheduling conflicts
- Group indecisiveness about "what to do" wastes time
- Doesn't want to manually manage multiple apps for planning

Persona 2

GERALD RICH

21 y.o

A structured student who juggles classes, work, and multiple friend groups — always looking for better ways to stay on top of everything.

LOCATION

Victoria
British Columbia, Canada

OCCUPATION

- Student at University of Victoria

TECH USE

- Regular Google Calendar and Apple Calendar user
- Comfortable syncing across devices

DIGITAL BEHAVIOR

- Checks Google Calendar daily
- Actively manages WhatsApp and Instagram friend groups
- Uses reminders and notifications to keep on track
- Engages with polls and collaborative planning tools

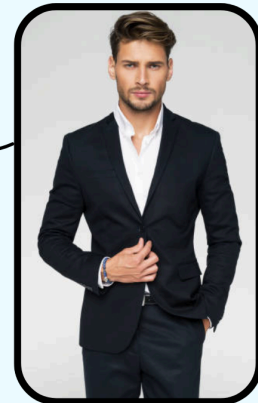
BACKGROUND

Gerald is an ambitious student balancing academics, part-time work, and a large social circle. He enjoys planning in advance and hates missing events with friends. He already uses Google Calendar to manage his schedule but struggles to coordinate across multiple groups.

GOALS:

- Avoid double-booking and missed events
- See group availability at a glance
- Keep social and academic schedules organized in one place

"A structured student who juggles classes, work, and multiple friend groups — always looking for better ways to stay on top of everything."



PAIN POINTS

- Stress from juggling multiple friend groups
- Coordination is chaotic when plans are spread across chats
- Often has to cancel or rearrange due to conflicts



JOURNEY MAPS

Journey map for Task 1

 PERSONA GERALD RICH SCENARIO CREATING PERSONAL SCHEDULE ON THE APP USER EXPECTATIONS Ability to load events of the week on to the schedule Ability to view the schedule and update it as required on a later date			
PHASE 1 DEFINE EVENTS THAT WILL TAKE PLACE DURING THE WEEK	PHASE 2 STRUCTURE WHEN THESE EVENTS WILL TAKE PLACE DURING THE WEEK	PHASE 3 INPUT THESE EVENTS INTO A PERSONAL SCHEDULE INTERFACE	PHASE 4 VIEW PERSONAL CALENDAR AND MAKE CHANGES TO IT DURING THE WEEK
DOING – Noting down events that are to take place during the week. – Viewing academic outlines and work schedules to confirm what events are taking place.	– Considering times during the week that would best suit specific tasks. – Thinking around class schedules to fit in time to study and work.	– Take the planned events and input them one by one into the calendar based interface. – Colour coding events as appropriate corresponding to the different categories of activities: study, work, class for example.	– View the finished calendar. – Moving events around when better pockets of time open up to complete them.
THINKING "What do I have to do this week?" "Do I have any exams or midterms coming up?"	"When can I study for my midterm on Friday?" "Will I be able to go to the gym after my late class Thursday?"	"How do I put my work time block into the calendar?" "How do I color code all my different time blocks into different colours according to the category of activity they correspond to?"	"I can actually get some more work done today instead of Thursday, let me change it?" "What do I have to do today after 6?"
SAYING "I have an assignment due Friday night" "I have a 4 hours of work Wednesday"	"I can go to the gym on Monday and Thursday" "I can study after class Tuesday"	"Let me make all work activities orange" "Let me create a time block for studying on Friday"	"Let me move my study block to Tuesday instead" "Let me see what I have to do after class tomorrow"
INSIGHTS Make it easy to switch time blocks around in order to make reorganization of schedules easy. Make it easy to categorize events into activity categories (in order to color code) while inputting them. Make it easy to change categories of events after inputting them.		INTERNAL OWNERSHIP Design Team: Make the interface to input events and edit them very usable. Back-end development team: Facilitate moving around and editing of a calendar to be time optimized.	

Journey Map for Task 2

 PERSONA GERALD RICH SCENARIO ABILITY TO JOIN MULTIPLE GROUPS USER EXPECTATIONS IT SHOULD BE EASY TO JOIN A GROUP MULTIPLE GROUPS IT SHOULD BE EASY TO VIEW SCHEDULES OF MEMBERS OF A GROUP UPON JOINING			
PHASE 1 DECIDING WHAT GROUPS HE WILL JOIN	PHASE 2 SEARCHING FOR THE GROUP HE WANTS TO JOIN	PHASE 3 JOINING THE GROUP	PHASE 4 VIEWING SCHEDULES OF THE PEOPLE IN THE GROUP
DOING – Thinking of which of his friend groups use the application – Looking up the group code of the groups he wants to join	– Searches up code of group he wants to join – Selects appropriate group after searching	– After selecting the appropriate group, he clicks on the JOIN button in order to join said group	– Upon joining the appropriate group, he is able to see the schedule of all the members that are a part of the group and the times during the week when they are free
THINKING "Does friend group A have a group calendar on Palendar?" "What is the code corresponding to friend group A?"	"Where can I find the search bar to input my code?" "Is this friend group A's group?"	"How do I join the group?" "Is there a button to do so?"	"What is Bob doing Thursday this week?" "Can we all hangout 4pm Saturday?"
SAYING "Let me join friend group A's calendar" "The code for friend group A is 978655373"	"Let me type 978655373 in the search bar" "I see friend group A's calendar group!"	"I see the button to join the group" "Let me click on the join' group button"	"This is great, we are all free Friday night" "I see friend group A's calendar!"
INSIGHTS – Searching for groups should be made easier – The join button should be visible and easy to access		INTERNAL OWNERSHIP Front-end team: Create a visible and usable search bar and an attractive JOIN button Back-end team: Be able to support multiple groups, ensure joining feature and search feature work well	

Journey Map for Task 3

NN/g CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP TEMPLATE

	PERSONA <u>Shanay Oberoi</u>	SCENARIO <u>Using the group calendar to plan ahead</u>	USER EXPECTATIONS <u>A central calendar that shows all group activities in one place.</u> <u>The ability to compare her own schedule with group events.</u>	
PHASE 1 <u>Identify Events and Commitments</u>	PHASE 2 <u>Check Group Calendar</u>	PHASE 3 <u>Organize Her Personal Schedule</u>	PHASE 4 <u>Plan Ahead with Confidence</u>	
DOING Shanaya scrolls through group chats and hears about different upcoming events.	She opens the shared group calendar to see all scheduled activities (study session Thursday, soccer game Saturday, birthday dinner Sunday).	Shanaya compares her personal commitments with the group calendar. She blocks time for important hangout and avoids overlapping	She confirms her availability for events and even suggests future hangouts based on the open days she sees.	
THINKING "There's too much to remember — what if I miss something?"	"Now I can actually see the full picture of what's happening this week."	"If I plan my errands on Friday, I'll be free for Saturday's game."	"This makes it easier to balance my work, classes, and social life."	
SAYING "Can someone remind me when the study session is?"	"Oh, I didn't realize the dinner was on Sunday — good thing I checked."	"Okay, I'll move my gym session so I can make the dinner."	"Looks like I'm free next Wednesday — let's plan something then!"	
INSIGHTS <u>The shared calendar helps Shanaya not just see availability but actively organize her</u> <u>life around group events. This feature reduces last-minute stress by giving a</u> <u>forward-looking view. Students like Shanaya use it to plan both short-term</u> <u>hangouts and future appointments.</u>			INTERNAL OWNERSHIP <u>Design Team: Create clear visual layouts for weekly/monthly group calendars.</u> <u>Engineering: Ensure reliable syncing so changes show up instantly.</u> <u>Promote the feature as "your group's central planner — no more missed hangouts."</u>	

Journey Map for Task 4

NN/g CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP TEMPLATE

 PERSONA <u>Shanaya Oberoi</u> SCENARIO Shanaya wants to hang out with friends but finds that plans often collapse because no one can quickly figure out when everyone is free. She uses group chats but gets frustrated with scheduling conflicts. USER EXPECTATIONS <u>Simple, clear way to see when friends are all free</u> <u>No manual checking of multiple calendars</u>			
PHASE 1 <u>Identify Events and Commitments</u>	PHASE 2 <u>Organize Availability</u>	PHASE 3 <u>Share and Sync Schedules</u>	PHASE 4 <u>Confirm Common Free Times</u>
DOING Notifies that friends are talking in the group chat about hanging out this weekend.	Friends start suggesting random times but conflicts pop up (labs, work shift other plans).	Messages keep piling up, with multiple people unavailable at different times	App highlights a common free slot that works for everyone
THINKING "I hope we can actually figure out a time this time..."	"Ugh, this is going to take forever!"	"Why is this so difficult? I just want to know when everyone's actually free!"	"Finally! This makes it so much easier."
SAYING "When are you guys free?"	"That doesn't work for me, I have class then"	"Okay, then when CAN we all meet?"	"Perfect, let's lock in Thursday at 6"
INSIGHTS <u>Students are willing to hang out, but wasted time in group chats leads to frustration and cancellations.</u> <u>Automatically surfacing common free times solves the biggest barrier: indecision</u>		INTERNAL OWNERSHIP <u>Product/Design Team: Build the "common free time" algorithm and group calendar view.</u> <u>Engineering Team: Integrate with Google/Apple Calendar APIs.</u> <u>Marketing/Engagement Team: Emphasize "make plans happen faster" as a value proposition.</u>	

DESIGN REQUIREMENTS

MUST BE MET

1. **Ability to create your own personal calendar in order to make your personal schedule available to your group in the application**

Justification: This is an essential feature of the app without which one will not be able to plan their time around their friends'

2. **Ability to join multiple groups**

Justification: This allows users to plan their weeks while accommodating multiple friend groups'/friends' schedules in mind without double booking

3. **Ability to view a group's calendar**

Justification: This allows users to view the schedules of all individuals that are a part of the group in the same place in order to facilitate easier planning of 'hangouts'

4. Group should inform members about common free times between members

Justification: If this is directly displayed, it allows users to find out common free times without the need of combing through everybody's schedules.

5. Ability to create a group

Justification: Users should be able to create a group that their friends are able to join

SHOULD BE MET IF POSSIBLE

1. Integration of Google calendar/Other Calendar Apps

Justification: This helps users directly upload their schedules into the app instead of having to create a secondary one on the app.

2. Gamification that rewards users when they spend more time with friends

Justification: Helps incentivize users to spend more time with their friends and thereby reap the positive social benefits of those activities

3. Having a group chat for every group in the app

Justification: Helps make our app an end-to-end solution for facilitating planning of events within groups

COULD BE MET

1. Ability to scan a paper calendar or schedule into the app

Justification: Helps users that plan their schedules in a handwritten manner to directly upload their schedules onto the app. This however may be an expensive operation that requires a camera and artificial intelligence.